

Vertigo



Mixed Climbing – West face, Remarkables
by Simon Williamson

Section News

Twitter

We're slowly building up our followers on Twitter. Don't forget to include @NZACWellington when you're tweeting about your latest trip / summit etc. We'll also be using Twitter to keep you up to date with section nights, trips, instruction and more.

Section Nights

We had a fantastic turnout at our September section night with a good crowd settling in to watch Valley Uprising. We'll be looking at doing something similar in the future.

Our October section night is double feature night but not movies this time round. Our first offering of the evening is Rohan Light covering risk management and decision making in the mountains. After Rohan's presentation we have Don French and Mark Henson who will provide us with information about what Tukino has to offer us for both summer and winter pursuits. More information on both of these presentations is available in the flyer on the following page.

Section Nights are at the Southern Cross, 39 Abel Smith Street, Te Aro, Wellington. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start at 6.00 pm with some nibbles provided – koha at the door. Grab a drink from the bar.

Gear for hire

Following on from last month's Vertigo the section committee has agreed that we will open up gear other than PLBs for hire. The PLBs continue to be available for a \$50 deposit. In general, all other gear will be hired out at \$5 per item per week. We are currently pulling together a database of all section gear available for hire but our gear stores include harnesses, helmets, shovels, probes, ice axes, snow stakes and crampons. We also have a number of transceivers – currently only two of these are digital transceivers while there are plenty of the non-digital variety. We'll be purchasing more digital transceivers soon. Due to the value of the digital transceivers they are available for hire at \$10 / week. If you're interested in hiring any gear please email wellington@alpineclub.org.nz with the details of what you need and when and we will advise availability and work out pickup and dropoff the gear.

NZAC Wellington Section's double feature night

Deciding to Survive

Risk management and decision making in the mountains

Rohan Light, international risk taker, organisational strategist and student of 'decision science' will explore how to handle the risk of incurring a stack of decision failures and avoid 'touching the void'. He will also take you on a trip into military history by illustrating decision failures in another type of life-and-death environment.

Rohan teaches strategic thinking at VUW and works in the area of risk-based management. He focuses on aligning around a clear vision and emphasises purpose, direction and choice in decision making. He applies his broad experience in farming, multinationals, start-ups and the like onto the alpine environment providing insights on behaviour that could save your life (and maybe make your business more successful as a bonus).



Hanging on to Tukino

Raconteurs, occasional climbers and number 8 wire specialists, Don French and Mark Henson will regale you with tall tales and true about the adventure that is the Tukino Alpine Sports Club, some of the rock they have held onto and some that they haven't plus a few photos they claim they took climbing mountains. More importantly they will outline plans for the upcoming rock climbing events at the Tukino lodge this summer.

Where: Southern Cross Hotel, Able Tasman Street, Wellington

When: 6pm, Wednesday 7th October

Entry: Gold coin Koha (includes fries if you get there early)

View from the Chair

I have heard a number of people complaining about the weather recently. What's to complain about, it's cold and wet and apparently snowing. Even if it means being locked down in a hut with a bunch of smellies, reading 2003 editions of the FMC bulletin and wishing you brought a full bottle of gas, not much beats being in the mountains. And so it is that the last two weekends have brought blizzard conditions on Ruapehu which bodes well for the upcoming post course and ski touring trips on October 30th to November 1st.

So far we have had a very active season with three successful snow craft courses ranging from Introductory (what's that white stuff), Basic (hey this is cool, I want to do more) to Intermediate (lets go climbing).

Section nights at the Southern Cross are increasingly popular with over 60 attending the showing of Valley Uprising. Next month we have Rohan Light, Don French and Mark Henson discussing risk management, and talking about Tukino's climbing opportunities. In November, Erik Bradshaw will be talking about his South Island ski traverse and we're currently working out a plan for a December get together. We'll advertise the November and December section nights on Facebook and Twitter as well as in the next Vertigo.

We also welcome Mark Johnston (he may have given you a discount at Bivouac – if not too late as he recently left) on to the committee to replace Allan Brent. It is great to have someone with committee experience even if it was a while ago and in South Africa.

Due to unprecedented popular demand, Scott and Vincent are back and putting together multi-pitch and trad climbing sessions. Places are filling fast so if you're interested please email the section or Scott (see article below) for more details.

We are also planning to run an outdoor first aid course for our instructors but if you're interested and depending on numbers we hope to make it available to members as well. Date, location and cost TBC. More information will be available within the next few weeks. If you're keen, email the section and we'll add your name to the list. The section will cover the course cost for active instructors and trip leaders.

I am pleased to let you know that we now have a home for our alpine gear. We have decided to make some of it available for rent for a flat rate of \$5 per item (\$10 for digital transceivers and PLB's are free but require a \$50 deposit) – see below for more details. Sorry we don't lend out ropes or slings but, if you are a club member, you get a 15% discount at Bivouac to buy your own.

Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips

The following table lays out some club trips that are being planned for the year. Please indicate your interest in leading or participating in these trips by emailing the committee at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Labour Weekend Friday October 23 - Monday October 26	Arrowsmiths - Cameron Hut (Inland Mid Canterbury)
30 October – 1 November	Two options to choose from : 1. Ruapehu trip for Snowcraft course participants but there may be space for others – for more information contact Mark Leslie on markdleslie@gmail.com 2. Ski touring from TASC lodge at Tukino (Ruapehu) – for more information contact Eric Duggan 021 350 161 or email wellington@alpineclub.org.nz
October (specific date TBC)	One day multi-pitch course at Fergs – date and costs to be advised. Please register your interest by contacting Scott on scottyt007@gmail.com
November	Te ao Whekere (seaward Kaikouras)
November / December	Family Trip TASC lodge at Tukino bivvy near crater (Ruapehu)
TBC	Trad Course over a weekend at Tukino – date and costs to be advised. Please register your interest by contacting Scott on scottyt007@gmail.com

Trip Reports

Vertigo Article: Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival 2015

By Stefan King

I recently attended the Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival, held in Queenstown on the famous mountain range. To be honest - only the "ice" part of the name really appealed, having just come back from Canada after doing some incredible winter climbing on their magnificent waterfalls. As I contemplated attending the festival, I recalled being on a top rope in the Canadian Rockies, scratching tools on blank, vertical rock with my arms screaming at me, failing in an effort to master the art of mixed climbing. The whole concept of tools on rock seemed strange to me outside of moderately angled mountaineering situations, but I gained an appreciation for how difficult and out-there technical mixed climbing actually is!

The Wellington Section decided on flying to Christchurch and then taking a minivan to Queenstown, which turned out to be a great idea compared with taking a ferry across the gap and driving the whole way from Picton. The drive on the way was breathtaking, especially through Tekapo - getting everyone super excited for the climbing ahead. What an awesome crew of people. We shared climbing stories, gear reviews (my favourite) and my stash of scroggin that was definitely going to last the whole trip was done in 20 minutes!

Opening night at the Queenstown Event Centre was a great way to meet a few of the other climbers, but I seriously have never seen so many down jackets in one room. It is always so great to be amongst fellow climbers. They just seem to be so much more down to earth than "normal" human beings and chatting with others about their future climbing ambitions always leaves me inspired and wanting to quit my job, buy an outrageous amount of 2-minute noodles, get on the road and live the dream again.



I teamed up with Eric on the first day of the Festival and we made our way up the ski field underneath the lifts over to the Remarkables West face. As we hiked up the hill, I came to the conclusion that jumping and hooking ice tools to the bottom of the chairs and hanging on would definitely work. Might help me get ahead of the pack on the Traverse for next year and actually complete it in a day.

Anyway, after a bit of careful traversing on soft snow we arrived at a crag on the west face and decided on a tasty looking line up the face, which we thought was grade M4, or was it M6+? "Ah f**k it, lets try it anyway, we can always come down". Eric stepped up and took the leads for the day with me following, good lad. He made some pretty bold moves in areas with really blank rock and a serious lack of good ice where I imagine there normally would be. Despite my attempts at being a delicate climber, a whole sheet of ice covering a slab broke off on me. The revised beta involved me performing probably the most uncoordinated chimney in the history of climbing -

with legs fully parted at an angle they didn't even know existed. I made a promise to myself to start doing yoga as soon as I got home. I'm going to yoga tomorrow, for sure.

On the third pitch we ended up simul-climbing due to lack of good protection, which spiced things up a bit. We chose a slightly different approach than the line mentioned in the guidebook due to it not



looking in the best of condition and ended up at a pretty out there move on the alternative line. This involved crappy snow and an overhanging move that, to be honest, I probably couldn't have even gone up second. Eric gave it a solid go and the only small bit of rock for his left crampon broke, providing him with a bit of hangtime. Luckily his cam placement held nicely. We ended up rappelling down the way we came, with the last one off an average chockstone and cord, with me recalling a phone call to my poor mother: "Seriously, don't even worry mum. Climbing is safe as". Eric was an awesome partner, super cool under pressure and with a ton of experience. Cheers mate, learned a lot!



Once off the climb we were treated to a spectacular sunset, with beautiful golden rays lighting up the Remarkables West face. The relaxing walk back across the face with the sunset was a great finish to what was an exciting and rewarding day up in the alpine!



The next day out involved a full (or not) traverse of both Double Cone and Single Cone on the Remarkables, starting from the bottom of the Remarkables Ski field. Double Cone is just beautiful, and from the East face it reminded me of some of the beautiful faces I had seen in the backcountry of British Columbia. This was the day I had been looking forward to for a while. Eric and myself met

an English lad named Angus going solo and we all set off together. Around the 3-minute mark it was very clear we were definitely not winning the "race" today, with the New Zealand version of Ueli Steck basically running up the hill in front while I contemplated taking off my pack to have some more gummy bears. After watching the video of Ueli soloing the Eiger the week before, I was convinced I would be just as rad on the Remarks Traverse... or not.



As we made our way up to the start of the ridge Eric had to turn around with a serious flu kicking in and making life pretty average. Kicking steps while coughing up blood is not an ideal day out in anyone's book. Angus and myself made our way up to the ridge in deep powder snow, which provided a much needed thigh workout and helped burn off a bit of the Fergburger from the night before, which I could still feel taking up a significant portion of my stomach. About halfway up the ridge on the fairly exposed face we got into some deep snow that had already seen a little bit of sun. It had already softened up and going was slow, but the position was superb. We pushed on to Double Cone, had some lunch and decided to turn around at that stage, as we were just taking too long. No records were going to be broken by us today! We waited for the other 2 parties behind us to pass, but they ended up turning around with the soft snow under foot along some of the traverse making everyone a little uneasy. Down climbing some of the sections got a little spicy and focus was essential to ensure we didn't get down to the ski field too much faster than we had planned.



Taking our time walking down with the groomers we shared some great stories of adventure to finish another awesome day out! Apparently the winning time across both Double Cone and Single Cone and back to the bottom was a little over 2 hours, which is outrageous considering the conditions. Hats off to those guys, those times are seriously impressive!



To finish off the trip we went for a little afternoon rock climbing just outside of Christchurch. Awesome little crag. My man-flu had come on pretty bad so I was more than happy belaying for the day and feeling sorry for myself. Eric did some really awesome trad routes and pulled off some yogi moves.



The kids had some practice placing protection. The Wellington Section will have a couple of pretty epic young climbers in Felix and Sefton, which will be awesome to see! They obviously have a huge passion for climbing already and learning the trade from Simon and Carolyn I have no doubt they will go on to do some inspiring stuff in the future.





It turned out to be a really great weekend with an awesome bunch of people! A massive thank you to the Wellington Section for the support, and allowing us to take part in what was an epic festival. Cheers to Daniel Joll and all the crew that put all the work into organising the event. It's just so great that they bring together climbers from all over New Zealand and hold this event! To all the Wellington crew – Simon, Carolyn, Eric, Bett, Aviette, Felix and Sefton (did I miss anyone), cheers for an awesome adventure. I really hope we can do another trip soon. 😊

Notices

Call for submissions for the 2015 New Zealand Alpine Journal.

Have you done a new route in New Zealand (alpine or rock)? Been on an overseas climbing expedition? Explored new passes or rarely visited valleys on skis or foot? Or do you have some mountain-inspired art, photography or poetry you'd like to share with the world?

We're compiling content for this year's NZAJ, and would love to hear from you. Please get in touch with the editor at editor@alpineclub.org.nz. Deadline for content is October 12.

K6 Pakistani Karakoram 2015 - Expedition Report



Changi Tower (the route followed the left hand skyline) and Scott Bennett climbing mixed terrain on route

Scott Bennett, Steve Swenson and Graham Zimmerman spent the summer of 2015 on a fruitful and very enjoyable expedition to the Pakistan Karakoram. They spent the months of July and August in the Nangmah Valley and during a season marked by poor conditions and bad weather in much of the range, were fortunate to open two beautiful and technical routes.

One of these first ascents was of Changi Tower a remote and technical 6500m rock tower and the other was the FA of the SW buttress of K6 West (7040m). The latter was a route which was chosen after the intended objective (the central pillar of the south face below K6 central) was deemed too dangerous to warrant an attempt. To read the full expedition report go to [Expedition Report](#).

Donation to Club Hut Fund – Splitn2



A grateful thanks to Richard and the team at Splitn2 for their annual donation to the NZAC Club Hut Fund. We value their ongoing support.

Splitn2.com give members a 10% discount online and donate 1% of the purchase price of any product to the Club Hut Fund. Members require a code to apply the discount online.

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

Photos wanted!!!!

The poster has a blue background with white and yellow text. At the top right, there is a silhouette of a person climbing a mountain. In the center, a large white camera icon is prominent. The text is arranged in a clear, hierarchical manner, starting with a large question, followed by a call to action, and then providing details about the request. The bottom right corner features the MSC logo and a 50th anniversary banner. The bottom left corner has a small white box with the slogan 'SAFER PLACES, SAFER ACTIVITIES, SAFER PEOPLE.'

Are you capturing your outdoor adventures?

We need your help!

The NZ Mountain Safety Council is looking for photos of New Zealand's great outdoors to support us in our mission to help people stay safe out there.

In particular, the MSC is looking for alpine environments and climbing, and, while we'd still like to see your epic landscape shots, it would be great to get some shots with people in them - with their permission of course.

If you have photos to offer, we would love to have a chat about how we might be able to work together!

Email us at: design@mountainsafety.org.nz

SAFER PLACES, SAFER ACTIVITIES, SAFER PEOPLE.

MSC
OUTDOOR SAFETY
NEW ZEALAND MOUNTAIN SAFETY COUNCIL

50TH ANNIVERSARY
— EST. 1965 —

Cactus discount



A reminder that members, receive a 10% discount (excluding discounted and promotional items) at Cactus – in-store (using your NZAC membership card) at 90 Fitzgerald Ave, Christchurch. Members can apply online to become pro-team members for online discounts. Cactus also donate a percentage of sales profit to NZAC for the club's Expedition Fund. We thank them for this ongoing extra support.

BMC International Winter Climbing Meet

Glenmore Lodge, Aviemore, Scotland

24 to 31 January 2016

The BMC is pleased to announce that next year's BMC International Winter Climbing Meet will be located in the Cairngorms (Scotland) which has some of the finest winter climbing in Britain. Your federation is invited to put forward two experienced winter climbers from your country. Preference will be given to climbers who have not attended a BMC International Meet before. Please note that if the meet is oversubscribed, places will be reduced to one per country.

Please complete the online application form by 19 October. The form is here:

<https://webforms.thebmc.co.uk/events/bmc-international-meets/federation-application-form-bmc-international-winter-climbing-meet-20>

Becky McGovern will contact all applying Federations by email by 27 October. Please do not make any bookings (flights, trains etc) until you have had confirmation from the BMC.

NZ adventure film Cloud Piercer

Anita Ross is an emerging filmmaker based in Wellington. A couple of years ago, she stumbled upon Freda Du Faur and fell in love with her story. Since then, she has been working on a feature film script, Cloud Piercer, of Freda's journey to the top of Mount Cook ever since.

Mountain climbers and outdoors people are one of the main target audiences for this project and she would like to connect as early as possible to establish connections, collect feedback and soak up knowledge from the community that will be invaluable in making this film.

Join the journey from script to screen at www.facebook.com/CloudPiercerMovie and @Cloud_Piercer.

Updated edition of The Darran Mountains in Winter - A Climbers' Guide

- 76 pages in glorious colour
- Updated and expanded general area information
- Revised route grades and descriptions
- Descriptions for all new routes since the 2006 guide
- Graded list

When you see this guide, you'll realise just how much scope there is for exploration in the Darrans, and also why it is the country's premier adventurous winter climbing area.

All proceeds from downloads of this item are being donated towards the Club Hut Fund to assist with the ongoing maintenance of the NZAC hut network.

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/the-darran-mountains-in-winter-a-climbers-guide>

Wellington Section 2015 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Treasurer	Mark Leslie	027 338 4458
Secretary & Vertigo editor	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Patron	John Nankervis	
Other Committee Members	Aviette Musin	021 0299 5390
	Mark Johnston	027 924 4178
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary		
Any media queries should be directed to:		
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer, Sam Newton	sam@alpineclub.org.nz



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Wellingtons Waterfront
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New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

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* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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www.hangdog.co.nz

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